Mengjia (Maggie) Hu

CONTACT INFORMATION

University of Maryland, College Park
Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics
7998 Regents Drive
College Park, MD 20742

Phone: (+1) 240-232-9993
Email: mhu12680@umd.edu

RESEARCH FIELDS

Empirical Industrial Organization
Environmental and Energy Economics

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park, 2021–Present
Ph.D. Candidate in Agricultural and Resource Economics
Expected May 2027

University of Chicago, 2020
M.A. in Public Policy; Certificate in Research Methods

Jilin University, 2019
B.A. in Economics

REFERENCES

Joshua Linn (co-advisor)
Professor
University of Maryland
linn@umd.edu

Chenyu Yang (co-advisor)
Assistant Professor
University of Maryland
cyang111@umd.edu

Louis Preonas
Associate Professor
University of Maryland
lpreonas@umd.edu

Maureen L. Cropper
Distinguished University Professor
University of Maryland
mcropper@umd.edu

WORKING PAPERS

"Foreign Entry, Local Sourcing, and Domestic Welfare: Evidence from Tesla's Entry into China" *(Job Market Paper)*

Abstract: A leading foreign manufacturer can hurt domestic rivals through competition and help them through spillovers that lower production and new-product introduction costs. I estimate a model of demand, pricing, and product introduction to study these forces in China's electric vehicle (EV) market following Tesla's launch of local production and component sourcing in 2019. Rival EV models sharing Tesla's core-part suppliers experienced larger marginal-cost declines than other rival EVs. After accounting for the corresponding size gap among gasoline models, I find that introduction costs for battery-electric vehicles (BEVs) in Tesla's size classes fell relative to those for smaller BEVs. Counterfactuals show that competition discourages rival introductions while cost spillovers encourage them, yielding 32 percent more rival offerings than in a market without Tesla's local production. Consumers receive most of the domestic welfare gain; endogenizing rival offerings increases their gain by about 27 percent. Domestic producer gains accrue mainly to EV start-ups, whose models share more suppliers with Tesla and are closer in size to its models, while established Chinese automakers lose.

"Geographic Resolution in Environmental Policy: EPA's Shift from Regions to Counties Under the Clean Air Act," with Maureen Cropper, Nicholas Muller, and Yongjoon Park. *NBER Working Paper 33412.*

"Unintended Consequences of Phytosanitary Regulation: Smuggling and Exotic Pest Risk," with Rebecca Epanchin-Niell.

WORKS IN PROGRESS	"GenAI and the Geography of Skill-Biased Deployment in the Energy Transition," with Victoria Wenxin Xie and Wu Zhu.
	"Housing Structure, Network Externalities, and Optimal Subsidy Dynamics," with Tianhua Zou, Joshua Linn, and Lunyu Xie.
PRESENTATIONS	2027: ASSA, AEA (scheduled, January). 2026: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (scheduled, November). 2025: AAEA; AERE@WEAI; UMD AREC 7th Annual Cornerstone Event. 2024: UMD AREC Research Workshop; UMD Annual AREC Poster Presentations.
TEACHING	**Teaching Assistant, University of Maryland, College Park** Introduction to Economics and the Environment (undergraduate), 2024 Applied Econometrics II (Ph.D. level), 2023 World Hunger, Population, and Food Supplies (undergraduate), 2021, 2022
FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS	2026–2027: Ann G. Wylie Dissertation Fellowship, University of Maryland 2025: Bruce and Mary Ann Gardner Dissertation Award, University of Maryland 2025: Goldhaber Travel Grant, Graduate School, University of Maryland 2021–2026: Graduate Assistantship, University of Maryland 2021: Graduate Student Fellowship, University of Maryland 2019: Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis (top 5%), Jilin University 2017–2018: College Excellent Student, Jilin University 2017–2018: Second Class Scholarship, Jilin University
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	**Research Consultant, Resources for the Future, 2024** *Retrospective Analysis of Environmental Regulation*
	Research Assistant, University of Maryland, College Park Joshua Linn and Louis Preonas, 2026 Rebecca Epanchin-Niell, Aug. 2024–Present Louis Preonas, Sep. 2023–Jan. 2024 Anna Alberini, Feb.–Jul. 2022
CODING SKILLS	Python, Stata, R, MATLAB, LaTeX
LANGUAGES	Mandarin Chinese (native); English (full professional proficiency)